

THE ULTIMATE LINKEDIN AI PLAYBOOK

Based on the Work of Ruben Hassid
From 0 to 770,000+ Followers Using AI

Original Article: "I uploaded 50 posts to ChatGPT with this prompt."

Compiled and recreated as a comprehensive playbook with
every detail from all linked resources.

COMPILED BY LAXMAN MEGHWAL

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Chapter 1: The Viral Formula Prompt

In January 2026, Ruben Hassid posted a simple message on LinkedIn that would go viral with hundreds of thousands of impressions. The message was deceptively simple: "I uploaded 50 posts to ChatGPT with this prompt. And it found my viral formula in 3 minutes." What followed was a step-by-step system that anyone could replicate to find the patterns hidden in their own LinkedIn content, turning random posting into a systematic, repeatable growth engine powered by artificial intelligence.

This playbook is the complete recreation of that system, expanded with every detail from every link Ruben shared. It is designed to be your definitive guide to using AI for LinkedIn growth. Every prompt, every technique, every tool recommendation, and every strategy has been extracted, organized, and presented here so you can start applying it immediately. This is not a summary or a highlights reel; it is the full, unabridged deep dive into how one of LinkedIn's most followed creators uses AI to consistently grow his audience and help others do the same.

1.1 The Original 6-Step Method

Ruben's original post laid out a simple, six-step process that anyone could follow, regardless of their technical skill level. The beauty of this method lies in its simplicity. You do not need to be an AI expert, a data scientist, or even a particularly skilled writer. You simply need access to ChatGPT (version 5.2 or later) with its "Thinking" mode enabled, and the willingness to look honestly at your own content history. The six steps are as follows:

- **Step 1:** Go to your LinkedIn account. Navigate to your activity feed where all your posts are visible.
- **Step 2:** Take screenshots of your last 20 LinkedIn posts. These should include both your "best" performers (high impressions, engagement, comments) and your "worst" performers (low impressions, minimal engagement).
- **Step 3:** Go to chatgpt.com and ensure you are using the latest version with "Thinking" mode turned on. This is critical because the reasoning capabilities of Thinking mode allow the AI to identify subtle patterns that standard mode would miss.
- **Step 4:** Turn on "Thinking" mode in ChatGPT 5.2. This activates the extended reasoning capability that lets the AI analyze content at a much deeper level.
- **Step 5:** Copy and paste the comprehensive prompt (provided in full below) into ChatGPT along with your screenshots.
- **Step 6:** Review the output carefully and apply the insights to your next posts.

1.2 The Complete Prompt

The following is the exact prompt that Ruben shared in his viral post. This prompt has been used by thousands of LinkedIn creators to analyze their content and discover their unique viral formula. It is designed to work in phases rather than all at once, which produces much better results than asking AI to do everything simultaneously. The phased approach ensures that the AI first diagnoses your content patterns thoroughly before attempting to prescribe solutions.

Act like a world-class LinkedIn content strategist and growth analyst.

Objective: Turn the user's uploaded "best" and "worst" LinkedIn posts (text/screenshots + any metrics) into a repeatable, personalized playbook. Keep the work lightweight by operating in phases, not all at once.

How to work:

- If metrics are provided, use them. If not, infer cautiously and label assumptions.
- Quote or reference exact lines/sections when you explain performance.
- Be blunt and specific (no generic advice).

PHASE 1 - Diagnosis (deliver this first, then stop and ask questions)

1) Rapid patterns (max 7 bullets): what winners share, what losers share, 3 do-more, 3 stop.

2) Post audit (for each post, max 10 lines):

- Winner/Loser verdict + 2-4 reasons tied to specific lines
- Keep / Change / Remove (bullets)
- One "biggest lever" to improve it

3) Winner DNA: a short checklist of repeatable ingredients (max 8 items).

PHASE 2 - Execution plan (only after the user answers your questions)

4) Double-down: 6 next-post concepts in the user's voice; each includes 2 hook options + a 5-bullet outline + CTA.

5) Repurpose: pick the top 2 winners and generate 2 repurpose angles each (choose: story, contrarian take, framework, case study) with mini-outlines.

Collaboration (end PHASE 1 with questions):

Ask 6 targeted questions to tailor PHASE 2 (ideal audience, goal, offer/CTA, voice boundaries, proof assets, cadence). Then propose 2 A/B tests and ask the user to pick one to run next.

Take a deep breath and work on this problem step-by-step.

What makes this prompt so effective is its structure. Instead of asking AI to "make me viral" (which produces generic advice), it forces the AI to be a diagnostician first. The AI must examine your actual content, identify specific patterns, and then create a personalized strategy based on evidence rather than assumptions. The "be blunt and specific" instruction is particularly important because AI tends toward pleasantries and vague advice unless explicitly told otherwise. This prompt cuts through that tendency and demands actionable, specific insights.

1.3 Why This Prompt Works Better Than Deep Research

Ruben boldly claimed that "This prompt just killed Deep Research." This is a strong statement, but it reflects an important insight about how AI should be used for content strategy. Deep Research mode in AI tools is designed for broad, exhaustive exploration of topics. It crawls the web, reads dozens of sources, and synthesizes findings. While this is valuable for certain tasks, it is not the right tool for finding your personal viral formula. Your viral formula is not found on the internet. It is hidden in your own content history, in the patterns of what has worked and what has not worked specifically for you and your audience.

The diagnostic prompt works because it focuses the AI's attention entirely on YOUR content. It does not search the web for generic LinkedIn tips. Instead, it analyzes the specific words, hooks, structures, and topics that have resonated with YOUR audience. This personalized analysis is far more valuable than any generic "viral LinkedIn post template" you might find online. Your audience is unique, your voice is unique, and your viral formula is unique. Only by studying your own history can you discover what works specifically for you.

1.4 Key Links from the Original Post

The original post referenced the following resources, all of which have been explored in depth in subsequent chapters of this playbook:

[Full guide on how AI will create more jobs than it replaces](#)

[Ruben Hassid's Blog: "How to AI"](#)

[Article: "1,000,000." - The complete LinkedIn growth strategy](#)

[Case Study: 10,000 followers in 17 days](#)

Chapter 2: The Road to 1,000,000 Followers

In his landmark Substack article titled "1,000,000.", Ruben Hassid posed a provocative question: "If you have access to AI, why can't you have 1 million followers on LinkedIn?" The article, published in February 2026, is perhaps the most comprehensive breakdown of his entire LinkedIn growth philosophy. It is not a quick-tip listicle or a motivational speech. It is a deep, unflinching examination of why most people fail to grow on LinkedIn despite having access to the most powerful content creation tools in human history, and exactly how to fix that.

2.1 The Hard Truth: AI Made the Easy Things Worthless

Ruben's central argument is counterintuitive and uncomfortable for many. He argues that AI has not made LinkedIn growth easier; it has actually made it harder in a very specific way. AI made what was valuable (the effort to start and the development of a reasonable strategy) "terribly easy" and therefore worthless. Before AI, simply writing a well-structured post with a decent hook gave you an advantage because most people could not or would not put in the effort. Now, anyone can generate dozens of well-structured posts in minutes. The barrier to entry has collapsed, which means the barrier to excellence has risen dramatically.

What remains valuable, according to Ruben, is two things: taste and consistency. Taste is the ability to recognize what is genuinely good, what resonates, what feels authentic and useful. Consistency is the discipline to show up every single day and publish, even when you do not feel like it, even when you are not sure if anyone is reading, even when your last three posts flopped. He is blunt about this: "And it turns out you have none of it. Clearly not enough to deserve 1,000,000 followers. For now." This is not an insult; it is a diagnosis. And like any good diagnosis, it comes with a treatment plan.

"AI made what was valuable terribly easy: the effort to start and a reasonable strategy. Both are now worthless. What is left is taste and consistency."

2.2 Nobody Cares About You

This is perhaps the most important lesson in the entire playbook, and it is the one that most people resist the most. Ruben explains it with brutal clarity: "No one cares about you." When you open an AI chatbot and prompt "Hey, this has been my achievement lately, make a viral LinkedIn post about it," you are making the fundamental mistake of assuming that strangers on the internet care about your achievements. They do not. Your personal posts might make your mom proud, your kids impressed (arguably), and your team or boss supportive. But they will not make new people excited about your journey or what you have to offer.

Readers only care about themselves. They read your post alone, facing a screen, with hundreds of life problems to deal with. Kids to pick up. Sick parents to call. Concert tickets to cancel. They are

not scrolling LinkedIn to read about your promotion. They are scrolling to find something useful, something that helps them solve a problem they are facing right now. The moment they sense that your post is about YOU rather than about THEM, they scroll past.

This insight leads to a powerful reframe: either you help your reader NOW, or they will not care enough to follow you. This is not about being selfless or altruistic; it is about understanding human psychology. People follow accounts that are useful to them. They praise personal posts of people they already know. If you want followers (not just praise), you must be useful, not personal.

2.3 Ruben's AI Topic Discovery Prompt

To help transform your expertise into content that readers actually care about, Ruben shared a specific prompt for Claude (his preferred AI tool). This prompt is designed to find the best angle and topic for a LinkedIn post that positions your expertise as something useful and relatable to the reader. Here is the complete prompt:

```
I want to find the best angle and topic for one LinkedIn post that turns my expertise into something useful, relatable, and 100% about the reader - not me bragging - by asking me clarifying questions about what real problem my audience is struggling with, what piece of my expertise would feel most useful to a stranger, and how to frame it so the reader sees themselves in it so that the post feels like the reader is reading about themselves and gives them a clear reason to follow me.
```

```
First, read the uploaded files completely before responding.
```

```
DO NOT start executing yet. Instead, ask me clarifying questions (use AskUserQuestion) so we can refine the approach together step by step.
```

```
Only begin work once we have aligned.
```

Notice the key instruction: "DO NOT start executing yet." This is a pattern that Ruben uses consistently across his work. He forces the AI to ask questions first, to understand the context, before generating any output. This produces dramatically better results than the typical approach of dumping a prompt and accepting the first response. The conversation between you and the AI IS the value, not just the final output.

2.4 The Art of the Hook: Breaking Patterns

Ruben dedicated an entire section of his strategy to the art of writing hooks. A hook is the first two lines of text on LinkedIn, which is exactly what people see before they have to click "... more" to read the rest of your post. If you can get people to click that button, you win. "Yes, social media is this easy," Ruben notes with characteristic directness. The hook is everything. If your hook fails, nothing else matters because no one will see it.

The fundamental principle behind great hooks is pattern interruption. You must "break the reader's pattern" and "wake him up from his slumber and doomscrolling." Readers are bored, understimulated. They are not yet sure whether they should care about your post. Your hook must shock them out of their scrolling trance and make them NEED to know what comes next. Ruben illustrates this principle with powerful examples from across disciplines:

- **Music:** Nirvana. Hair metal was king. Then Kurt Cobain showed up with a \$20 guitar and killed it in one song.
- **Painting:** Picasso. Everyone was painting what they saw. He painted what they felt. People hated it. Then they could not stop looking.
- **Device:** iPhone. Every phone had a keyboard. Steve Jobs removed it. The entire industry called him insane. Then they all copied him.
- **Software:** Google. Every homepage was a cluttered mess of links and ads. Google gave you a white page and a box.
- **Thinker:** Galileo. Everyone agreed the sun moved around us. He said no. They put him in prison. He was right.

2.5 The Hook Writing Prompt

After creating your post draft using the topic discovery prompt, Ruben provides a follow-up prompt specifically for crafting hooks. This prompt uses Claude's capabilities to generate multiple hook variations organized by psychological technique. Here is the complete hook prompt:

```
Now let us write the hook for this post - the first 2 lines readers see before they have to click "... more" on LinkedIn (roughly 2 short sentences of ~55 characters max each).
```

```
The hook's only job is to break the reader's scrolling pattern and make them NEED to click "... more." It should feel like a pattern interrupt - something unexpected, counterintuitive, or so specific the reader thinks "wait, what?"
```

```
<rules>
```

- ```
- The hook must be about the READER or a universal tension - never about me.
- It should create an open loop: an unanswered question, a contradiction, or a bold claim the reader cannot ignore.
- Avoid anything that sounds like a personal achievement, no emoji openers, no hashtags.
- It should feel like something a friend would text you that makes you reply "wait, explain."
```

```
</rules>
```

```
<hook_techniques>
```

```
1. Contradiction - say something that sounds wrong ("The worst LinkedIn posts get the most followers.")
2. Specific number + unexpected context ("I mass-unfollowed 2,000 people. My engagement tripled.")
3. Direct accusation - call the reader out ("You are writing LinkedIn posts for your mom, not your audience.")
4. Stolen thought - say what the reader secretly thinks but will not say out loud
5. Absurd reframe - take something mundane and make it dramatic
</hook_techniques>
```

Generate 10 hook options organized by technique. For each, write the exact 2 lines as they would appear on LinkedIn (keep it tight - every character counts). To generate the 10 hook options, generate a AskUserQuestion form.

## 2.6 Media That Works: Beyond Text

Ruben emphasizes that the media (image, video, or PDF) you attach to your LinkedIn post is the most important part of the post because it takes up most of the screen. He provides a powerful analogy: "It is like writing a book and not having a proper cover. People buy books because of the cover (79%) or the back cover (82%)." Your LinkedIn media IS your book cover. Most people get this wrong.

Here are the biggest misconceptions Ruben identifies about LinkedIn media, along with the truth behind each one:

- **Myth:** "The text is what matters." **Reality:** Only the hook and your media matter. A wall of text will not help you.
- **Myth:** "Videos are the best formats." **Reality:** People do not watch many videos on LinkedIn because they are supposed to be working, not binge-watching.
- **Myth:** "I need a strong recognizable brand for my media." **Reality:** The more it looks like an ad, the worse the post performs. Be scrappy.

According to Ruben, the best LinkedIn media format is a **1080 x 1350 single image** that looks scrappy and unbranded. It should feel organic, like something a real person would share, not like a polished advertisement. The ideal media is useful enough that someone would want to bookmark it or send it to a colleague. This is the opposite of an ad. Ads repel; useful content attracts.

## 2.7 The AI-Powered Infographic Method

Ruben provides a complete workflow for creating LinkedIn infographics using AI. This method uses Pinterest for inspiration and Gemini for content extraction and recreation. Here is the step-by-step process:

- **Step 1:** Go to Pinterest and search for your niche plus "graph" or "cheat sheet" or "infographic". For example, "rare earth infographic" or "AI tools cheat sheet".
- **Step 2:** Download the best-looking infographic you find.
- **Step 3:** Go to gemini.com and upload the downloaded image with this prompt:

Extract all of the information from this infographic so another designer could remake it. Your goal is to brief it, as if the designer was Gemini nano-banana (reverse prompting).

Make sure to use the Thinking model (bottom right in Gemini).

- **Step 4:** Go back to Pinterest and find a "handwritten style" infographic that feels organic. Your goal is to NOT look like an ad.
- **Step 5:** Return to Gemini and follow up with this prompt:

Now remake this infographic with the information, but with this style I just uploaded (copy only the style, your content comes from what you just shared).

The result is a professional-looking infographic that contains useful information from your niche but has an organic, handwritten style that does not look like a corporate advertisement. As Ruben notes, "A designer could charge hundreds of dollars for this." The entire process takes about 5 minutes and costs nothing.

## 2.8 The Consistency Imperative

Perhaps the most uncomfortable section of Ruben's strategy is his treatment of consistency. He compares people who expect LinkedIn growth while posting twice a month to someone who expects a bodybuilder's body while working out twice a month. The analogy is harsh but accurate. He shares his own Notion calendar, noting that he "never missed a day in 3 years." The expected growth from consistency is approximately 1,000 new followers per day, which he has sustained for years.

Ruben is particularly blunt about the excuses people make: "There is no secret AI prompt to make you consistent. If you can't post once a day and dedicate 30 minutes of your time, you won't make it. Because others do." He points out that "someone infinitely dumber than you is getting what you want in life by simply being consistent and using AI smartly." This is both a challenge and an encouragement. The playing field has been leveled by AI; the differentiator is no longer skill or knowledge but consistency and taste.

Ruben also addresses a deeper psychological issue: many people do not actually want what they say they want. "I could give you the entire playbook to one million followers, and you won't follow it. Because deep inside, you don't know if this is worth pursuing." He encourages readers to pick a target, pursue it with everything they have using AI, and make their advantage "so unfair it feels insurmountable to catch up with you." The key insight is that action produces information, and AI

has made action incredibly easy. Every action you take teaches you something that refines your strategy. The people who learn the fastest are the ones who take the most action, and AI has removed virtually every barrier to taking action.

## 2.9 Important Links from This Chapter

[Article: "1,000,000." - The Complete LinkedIn Growth Strategy](#)

[Ruben Hassid's "How to AI" Newsletter \(488,000+ subscribers\)](#)

[Article: How to set up Claude the right way](#)

# Chapter 3: Case Study - 10,000 Followers in 17 Days

In December 2025, Ruben Hassid and Anisha Jain published what Ruben called "my Christmas gift" and "by far the most ambitious course I have ever written." It was a complete, documented case study showing how Ruben grew his newest employee's LinkedIn account from 37 connections and 49 followers to over 10,000 followers in just 17 days, using only AI and organic growth strategies. This chapter extracts every detail from that case study.

## 3.1 The Starting Point

The subject of the case study was Maria Zhanette, Ruben's newest employee. On November 18, 2025, her LinkedIn account had exactly 37 connections, 49 followers, zero posts, and zero post impressions. She was starting from absolute zero. By December 5, just 17 days later, her account had over 10,000 followers (it eventually reached 18,000). The total impressions grew from zero to over 1.4 million. This was not a fluke; Ruben had done the same thing multiple times before, growing five different LinkedIn accounts to a combined 1.56 million followers organically.

## 3.2 Profile Picture Optimization

The first and most visible element of any LinkedIn profile is the profile picture. Ruben's advice here is specific and actionable. Your profile picture must pass the "distance test": when viewed from a distance in the LinkedIn comment section (where profile pictures are small), a person should be able to see two things: a smile and a color, without any background clutter. Here are the specific rules:

- **Smile way more than you think.** A genuine smile makes you instantly more approachable and trustworthy. This is not optional; it is a requirement.
- **Own a color.** Choose one dominant color for your background or clothing that makes you instantly recognizable when people scroll through comments. This becomes your visual signature.
- **Zoom until your entire face is the only thing visible.** The photo should be a close-up of your face and shoulders, not a full-body shot or a wide-angle photo.
- **Declutter the background.** A solid, hard color background works best. Remove any distracting elements behind you.

Ruben reveals that his own profile picture was created by AI, using Gemini and a tool called Nano-Banana Pro. The process involves uploading a picture of yourself (HD quality needed) and a picture of a profile picture you admire, then using this prompt:

Generate a corporate headshot of my image in [how you are dressed] in the same style as the 2nd image I uploaded as an inspiration.

Alternatively, you can use a detailed standalone prompt that specifies exact camera settings, lens, lighting, and styling. The key parameters include an 85mm f/1.8 lens with shallow depth of field, bright diffused studio lighting, a solid neutral background color, and instructions for clean cinematic color grading. This prompt alone can save you hundreds of dollars on a professional headshot.

### 3.3 Crafting Your Mission and Headline

Your LinkedIn headline is visible everywhere on the platform: in comments, in posts, in search results, and on your profile. It is the single most important piece of text on your entire LinkedIn presence. Ruben frames this as being known as "the [X] guy" or "the [X] person." You are one step in someone's journey to being better at [X]. Once you understand this, you must write the most compelling one-liner possible for your headline.

Here are examples from Ruben's team:

Person	Mission	Headline
Ruben Hassid	Help people use AI without coding to always be ahead of the technology	"Master AI before it masters you."
Maria Zhanette	Cut through the noise and curate the content creators that matter	"I curate who is worth your attention."

Table 1: Mission and Headline Examples

To help you craft your own, Ruben created a free Custom GPT called "Mission GPT" that guides you through the process of discovering your unique value proposition and crafting a compelling headline. You can access it at [chatgpt.com/g/g-67530e1fbc8c819186a9cae1fc734cfe-mission-gpt](https://chatgpt.com/g/g-67530e1fbc8c819186a9cae1fc734cfe-mission-gpt) by clicking "Start" and answering the questions.

### 3.4 Define Your Ideal Customer Profile (ICP)

One of the most powerful concepts Ruben introduces is the Ideal Customer Profile (ICP). This is the single most important strategic decision you will make for your LinkedIn presence. The rule is: "If you market to everyone, you market to no one." You are not making content for millions; you are creating content for exactly ONE person. Ruben provides vivid examples of well-known creators and their ICPs:

- **Alex Hormozi** talks to "Ryan" - a 37-year-old male agency owner running a \$4M/year digital marketing agency, exhausted from inconsistent client acquisition, desperate to build predictable, high-margin systems.

- **Jordan Peterson** talks to "Ethan" - a 24-year-old male college graduate feeling lost and aimless, struggling with depression and lack of direction, searching for profound meaning through personal responsibility.
- **Andrew Huberman** talks to "David" - a 42-year-old male tech executive working 70-hour weeks, obsessed with maximizing cognitive performance.
- **Ruben Hassid** talks to "Sophia" - a 40-year-old female management consultant in Europe, billing \$1,000/day, anxious about AI integration demands but lacking confidence to teach non-technical teams.

Ruben also provides a free Custom GPT called "ICP GPT" (available at [chatgpt.com/g/g-89NEaQgUI-icp-gpt](https://chatgpt.com/g/g-89NEaQgUI-icp-gpt)) that helps you discover your own ICP. Once you have your mission and ICP defined, Ruben recommends two additional AI tools: "Red Searcher" to find the most viral pain points of Reddit in your niche, and "AI Editor" to ensure your content does not sound like it was written by AI (more on this in Chapter 5).

## 3.5 Important Links from This Chapter

[Full Case Study: 10,000 Followers in 17 Days](#)

[Mission GPT - Free Custom GPT for crafting your LinkedIn mission](#)

[ICP GPT - Free Custom GPT for discovering your ideal customer profile](#)

# Chapter 4: LLM Battle - Making AI Fight for Truth

In June 2025, Ruben published one of his most innovative articles: "How to make AI battle for you." The concept is both simple and profound. Instead of relying on a single AI tool, Ruben makes ChatGPT and Claude "fight" each other to arrive at better answers. He calls this technique "LLM Battle" (LLM stands for Large Language Model). The core insight is that AI models frequently suffer from confirmation bias, where they agree with whatever you say rather than challenging your assumptions. By pitting two different AI models against each other, you can dramatically reduce this bias and arrive at much more reliable conclusions.

## 4.1 Understanding AI Confirmation Bias

Confirmation bias in AI is the tendency of language models to favor information that confirms your prior beliefs. Basically, as Ruben puts it, "LLMs are often Yes-men who never second guess you (or themselves)." This is a fundamental limitation of how these models are trained. They are optimized to produce text that is fluent and contextually appropriate, not text that is necessarily true or that challenges the user. When you ask ChatGPT a question, it tends to give you an answer that aligns with the framing of your question, even if that framing is flawed.

The result is that AI can give you very bad advice that sounds very convincing. In Ruben's own example, when he asked ChatGPT for LinkedIn growth advice, it initially gave an excellent answer. But when he asked for more tips, ChatGPT suggested launching a newsletter within LinkedIn (which Ruben knows is a bad idea), going live once a month on LinkedIn (which gives little views), and writing two collaborative articles for a badge (which does not exist anymore). Three extremely bad pieces of advice, all delivered with the same confidence as the good advice.

## 4.2 The LLM Battle Framework

The LLM Battle framework is a three-step process designed to counter confirmation bias by using two independent AI systems to validate and challenge each other's outputs. Here is the complete framework:

### Step 1: Start with ChatGPT

Always start with ChatGPT using the o3 model with search activated. ChatGPT's agentic capabilities (its ability to search and reason through the web) are often unmatched. Use it to get your initial answer to a complex question. Ask follow-up questions to get the most complete answer possible. The key is to push ChatGPT until it starts giving you advice you are unsure about.

### Step 2: Confront ChatGPT with Claude

Copy ChatGPT's answer and paste it into Claude with this specific prompt:

```
Act as [expert].

I want you to either confirm or confront, with extreme precision, what
another [expert] told me.

I first asked the following: [original prompt]

I attached its first answer: [copy and paste ChatGPT's answer]

I want to make sure I don't blindly follow its lead and I actually
follow best practices for the goal I originally set up.
```

Claude will analyze ChatGPT's answer and point out flaws, contradictions, and bad advice. In Ruben's example, Claude immediately identified that launching a LinkedIn newsletter is too early for a new account, that the quality of comments matters more than quantity, and that the top voice badge has been killed. This is the value of the battle: Claude catches what ChatGPT misses, and vice versa.

### Step 3: Make Them Battle Until They Agree

Continue the conversation on both sides, asking the same questions. When you find a disagreement, present Claude's position to ChatGPT and vice versa. Keep going until they reach agreement. The final agreed-upon answer is far more likely to be correct than anything either model would have produced alone. Ruben demonstrates this beautifully in his article when he identifies that both models incorrectly promote having a newsletter within LinkedIn. By pushing both models on this specific point, he eventually gets Claude to acknowledge that ChatGPT's approach of avoiding LinkedIn-only dependency is the better long-term strategy.

## 4.3 The "Perspective Transitioning" Prompt

For situations where you do not have time to run a full LLM Battle, Ruben provides a single prompt that simulates the same process within a single conversation. This "Perspective Transitioning" prompt forces the AI to consider multiple expert viewpoints:

```
Let us take a step back in our conversation.

I will use a prompting technique called "Perspective Transitioning" to
avoid falling into confirmation bias.

You will enact two completely different experts to fully read our
conversation, and critic our discussion, learnings and conclusions.
Their critics is based on science, truth, deep search and expertise on
the matter.
```

```
Step 1: Pick these two completely different experts.
Step 2: Re-read our entire conversation, from the first prompt to the
last.
Step 3: Share the first expert point of view.
Step 4: Share the second expert point of view.
```

This prompt is particularly useful for long, complex conversations where you have been going back and forth with the AI and want to ensure you have not fallen into an echo chamber. It works because it forces the AI to adopt personas that may disagree with its own previous responses, breaking the confirmation bias pattern.

## 4.4 The 30-Second Playbook vs. Hallucinations

Ruben also provides a practical, quick-reference guide for dealing with AI hallucinations (when AI confidently states things that are not true). He explains that LLMs do not actually "lie" because lying requires intent. Instead, they are fulfilling their training objective of predicting the next token that looks right, regardless of whether it corresponds to reality. Here is his five-point anti-hallucination playbook:

- **Ask for receipts.** Tell the model to "List sources next to every claim." This forces the AI to ground its statements in verifiable information.
- **Let them pass.** Tell the model it CAN answer "I don't know." This simple instruction dramatically reduces hallucination because the model no longer feels obligated to produce an answer for every question.
- **Lower temperature.** Use temperature 0.2 for factual questions and 0.8+ for brainstorming. Lower temperature means more conservative, fact-aligned outputs.
- **Ground them early.** Feed your own documents and data rather than expecting the model to search for information on its own.
- **Use LLM Battle.** Run the same question through both ChatGPT and Claude and compare. If they disagree, investigate further.

## 4.5 Important Links from This Chapter

[Article: How to make AI battle for you](#)

# Chapter 5: Claude Cowork - The End of Prompting

In March 2026, Ruben published what he called the "full playbook of Cowork." Claude Cowork represents a fundamental paradigm shift in how humans interact with AI. When Claude released this feature, software stocks lost \$830 billion in six days because the market recognized that Cowork fundamentally changes the relationship between humans and AI. Ruben believes software has lost \$2.5 trillion in valuation since Cowork was introduced. This chapter covers the complete setup and usage of Claude Cowork, extracted from Ruben's extensive guides.

## 5.1 Why Prompting Is the Worst Way to Use Claude

The title of Ruben's April 2026 article says it all: "Prompting is the worst way to use Claude." He explains that when you write a prompt like "Write me a LinkedIn post about X," you are not giving Claude enough context. You are not explaining your tone, your audience, your rules, your preferences. Everything that makes your content uniquely yours is missing. The result is output that sounds like everyone else's AI-generated content. But who wants to type 500 words of instructions just to get a first draft? Nobody does. So you do not, and the output sounds generic.

The solution is Claude Cowork. With Cowork, you create text files that contain everything about you: your writing style, your company's rules, your best examples, your past work, and what you hate. These files are saved in a folder on your computer that Claude reads automatically before every session. The files ARE the prompt, forever. You never need to type a long prompt again because Claude already knows everything about you before you start typing.

"With Cowork, the game is text files. Take everything you know and put it in text files. Drop them in a folder. Point Claude to that folder. It is like having an SOP for an employee, but Claude is your employee and the SOP is your Cowork folder."

## 5.2 Claude Product Line Overview

Before diving into Cowork, it is helpful to understand where it fits in Claude's product ecosystem:

- **Claude Chat:** The basic chat interface, similar to ChatGPT. Good for quick questions.
- **Claude Project:** Like Claude Chat but organized into separate Projects. Better for ongoing work.
- **Claude Code:** A revolution for developers to code much faster. Not for non-coders.
- **Claude Cowork:** Like Claude Code but for knowledge workers. This is where you should focus.
- **Claude Skills:** Teach Claude repeatable workflows. Better than Projects.

- **Claude Connectors:** Plug Claude directly into apps like Slack, Google Calendar, Gmail. It reads, writes, and acts inside the tools you already use.
- **Claude Plugins:** Like Connectors but you create them yourself.

## 5.3 Setting Up Your Claude Cowork Folder

The Cowork folder is the heart of the entire system. It is a folder on your computer that Claude has read/write access to. Everything Claude needs to know about you goes in this folder, and everything Claude produces gets saved to this folder. Here is the exact folder structure Ruben recommends:

Folder	Purpose	Key Files
ABOUT ME/	Your identity, taste, and writing rules	about-me.md, anti-ai-writing-style.md
PROJECTS/	Live work organized by project	Briefs, drafts, references per project
TEMPLATES /	Reusable patterns from past work	Proven structures as templates
CLAUDE OUTPUTS/	Where Claude delivers finished work	Organized by project

Table 2: Claude Cowork Folder Structure

## 5.4 The Global Instructions Prompt

After setting up your folder, you configure Claude's behavior using Global Instructions. These are accessed via Settings, then Cowork, then Edit Global Instructions. Here is the exact Global Instructions that Ruben uses:

```
GLOBAL INSTRUCTIONS

BEFORE EVERY TASK
1. Read ABOUT ME/. No task starts without reading both files.
2. If the task relates to a project, read everything in the matching PROJECTS/ subfolder before proceeding.
3. If the task involves a content type that has a matching pattern in TEMPLATES/, study that template's structure first. Use the structure. Don't copy the content.

FOLDER PROTOCOL
You have three read-only folders and one write folder.
```

```
Read-only - never create, edit, or delete anything here:
- ABOUT ME/ - My identity and writing rules.
- TEMPLATES/ - Proven structures to reuse as patterns.
- PROJECTS/ - My briefs, references, and finished work organized by
project.

Write folder - the only place you deliver work:
- CLAUDE OUTPUTS/ - Everything you create goes here. Organize with one
subfolder per project.

NAMING CONVENTION
All files you create must follow this format:
project_content-type_v1.ext
Content types: Newsletter, LinkedIn Post, Brief, Deck, Report.

OPERATING RULES
- If the brief is unclear or incomplete, use the AskUserQuestion tool.
Don't fill gaps with generic filler.
- Don't over-explain. Deliver the work. Save the commentary unless I
ask for it.
- Never delete files anywhere.
```

This Global Instructions setup means that your daily prompts can be as short as 10 words and still produce work that sounds like you, with the same level of quality as if you had written 500 words of instructions. Claude reads your entire context folder before every session, so it already knows your style, preferences, and rules.

## 5.5 AskUserQuestion: Let AI Prompt You

One of the most powerful features of Claude Cowork is the AskUserQuestion tool. By adding the instruction "Start by using the AskUserQuestion tool before answering" to any prompt, Claude generates an interactive form with actual buttons, clickable options, multi-select choices, and ranking drag-and-drop interfaces. Ruben calls this "AI finally prompting YOU." Instead of you writing long, detailed prompts, Claude asks you the questions it needs answered to do its best work.

This completely inverts the traditional AI interaction model. Instead of you telling Claude what to do, Claude tells you what information it needs. The options Claude provides give you a direction, but you still make the final decisions. It is like having a smart employee who asks clarifying questions before starting work rather than making assumptions and producing mediocre results. For example, Ruben adds this to a simple prompt about writing a LinkedIn post, and Claude automatically generates options based on his "about me" file, including insights like "Nobody followed you because of your breakfast" (a specific writing rule from Ruben's preferences).

## 5.6 Obsidian: Making Cowork Manageable

One of the biggest complaints about Claude Cowork is that managing markdown (.md) files is difficult for non-technical users. When you double-click an .md file, it opens in a plain text editor that looks like code. Ruben's solution is Obsidian, a free application that turns your Cowork folder into a beautiful, easy-to-navigate knowledge base. Obsidian reads your Cowork folder and displays every file with proper formatting, a sidebar for navigation, and full-text search across everything. You can click a file, see it rendered with headers, bold text, bullet points, and the whole thing, and edit it right there. Any changes you make in Obsidian are automatically saved to the folder that Claude reads from. This means you can update your AI's "brain" as easily as editing a Google Doc.

## 5.7 Important Links from This Chapter

[Download Claude Desktop App \(required for Cowork\)](#)

[Article: How to set up Claude Cowork \(complete guide\)](#)

[Article: Claude Cowork + Project](#)

[Article: Prompting is the worst way to use Claude](#)

[Obsidian - Free app for managing Claude Cowork files](#)

# Chapter 6: Complete Resource Directory

This chapter serves as a comprehensive reference guide containing every link, tool, and resource mentioned across all of Ruben Hassid's content that was used to create this playbook. Use this as your quick-access hub for everything you need to implement the strategies described in this playbook.

## 6.1 All AI Tools Referenced

- **ChatGPT 5.2 (with Thinking mode):** [chatgpt.com](https://chatgpt.com) - The primary AI tool for the viral formula prompt. Use o3 model with search for best results.
- **Claude (with Cowork):** [claude.com/download](https://claude.com/download) - Ruben's preferred AI for daily content creation. Requires Pro account (\$20/month).
- **Gemini (with Thinking model):** [gemini.com](https://gemini.com) - Used for infographic creation and content extraction.
- **Grok:** Used for extracting Reddit trends and data.
- **Mission GPT:** [chatgpt.com/g/g-67530e1fbc819186a9cae1fc734cfe-mission-gpt](https://chatgpt.com/g/g-67530e1fbc819186a9cae1fc734cfe-mission-gpt) - Free Custom GPT for crafting your LinkedIn mission statement.
- **ICP GPT:** [chatgpt.com/g/g-89NEaQgUI-icp-gpt](https://chatgpt.com/g/g-89NEaQgUI-icp-gpt) - Free Custom GPT for discovering your Ideal Customer Profile.
- **Red Searcher:** Custom GPT for finding viral Reddit pain points in your niche.
- **AI Editor:** Custom GPT for avoiding AI-sounding writing.
- **Nano-Banana Pro:** Used for generating professional AI headshots.

## 6.2 All Articles Referenced

- **"I uploaded 50 posts to ChatGPT with this prompt"** - The original viral LinkedIn post that started this playbook.
- **"1,000,000."** - The complete LinkedIn growth strategy ([ruben.substack.com/p/1000000](https://ruben.substack.com/p/1000000)).
- **"10,000 followers in 17 days."** - The complete case study with Anisha Jain ([ruben.substack.com/p/from-49-to-10000-followers-in-17](https://ruben.substack.com/p/from-49-to-10000-followers-in-17)).
- **"How to make AI battle for you."** - The LLM Battle framework ([ruben.substack.com/p/fight](https://ruben.substack.com/p/fight)).
- **"Prompting is the worst way to use Claude."** - The Claude Cowork + Obsidian guide ([ruben.substack.com/p/stop-prompting-claude](https://ruben.substack.com/p/stop-prompting-claude)).
- **"Cowork."** - The complete Claude Cowork setup guide ([ruben.substack.com/p/claude-cowork](https://ruben.substack.com/p/claude-cowork)).
- **"Claude."** - How to set up Claude the right way ([ruben.substack.com/p/claude](https://ruben.substack.com/p/claude)).

- **"How to set up Claude Cowork + Project."** - April 2026 update  
([ruben.substack.com/p/claude-cowork-project](https://ruben.substack.com/p/claude-cowork-project)).

## 6.3 Essential Platforms

- **How to AI (Newsletter):** [how-to-ai.guide](https://how-to-ai.guide) - Ruben's Substack newsletter with 488,000+ subscribers. 2 emails per week with step-by-step AI workflows.
- **Pinterest:** [pinterest.com](https://pinterest.com) - Used for finding infographic inspiration and style references.
- **Reddit:** [reddit.com](https://reddit.com) - Goldmine for finding viral pain points and trending topics in your niche.
- **Obsidian:** [obsidian.md](https://obsidian.md) - Free app for managing Claude Cowork markdown files.
- **LinkedIn:** [linkedin.com](https://linkedin.com) - The primary platform for implementing all strategies in this playbook.

## 6.4 Quick-Start Action Plan

If you are overwhelmed by the amount of information in this playbook, here is a simplified, step-by-step action plan to get you started immediately. Follow these steps in order:

Step	Action	Time
1	Download Claude desktop app and set up Cowork with your folder structure	30 min
2	Create your about-me.md and anti-ai-writing-style.md files	20 min
3	Install Obsidian and connect it to your Cowork folder	10 min
4	Take screenshots of your last 20 LinkedIn posts (best and worst)	15 min
5	Run the Viral Formula Prompt (Chapter 1) with your screenshots	10 min
6	Define your mission statement using Mission GPT	10 min
7	Define your ICP using ICP GPT	10 min
8	Create or update your profile picture using the AI headshot prompt	10 min
9	Start posting daily using Claude Cowork for content creation	30 min/day

10	After 2 weeks, re-run the Viral Formula Prompt to track improvement	10 min
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Table 3: Quick-Start Action Plan

"Pick a target. Pursue it with all of your heart, using AI, and everything you can, to have the unfair advantage you really want. Make your advantage so unfair it feels insurmountable to catch up with you."

## 6.5 Final Words from Ruben Hassid

Throughout all of his content, Ruben Hassid returns to one central theme: the combination of AI tools and human taste and consistency is the most powerful competitive advantage available today. He grew his own account from 8,000 followers (pre-ChatGPT) to 770,000 followers in three years. He did the same with five different LinkedIn accounts for a combined 1.56 million followers, all organically. He documented growing an employee's account from 49 to 18,000 followers in under a month.

His message is clear: the tools are available, the strategies are proven, and the knowledge is freely shared. The only thing standing between you and extraordinary LinkedIn growth is your willingness to take consistent action, refine your taste through iteration, and leverage AI as the multiplier it was designed to be. As Ruben says: "Humanly yours."